Lesson 7 — The Bench by the Stairs

Part 6 of 12: Comprehension — a full TOEFL set of ten

Level: B1 (seventh step)

About 45 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

Part A — Multiple choice

> This is a full set of ten, the size of a real TOEFL reading set.

1. (Factual) On which days do the students sit at the bench?

   A. Every afternoon.
   B. Sunday, Tuesday and Thursday.
   C. Thursday only.
   D. Whenever a machine arrives.

2. (Factual) What does Maysa study?

   A. Engineering.
   B. Accounting.
   C. Information systems.
   D. The passage does not say.

3. (Negative factual) According to the passage, all of the following are rules at the bench EXCEPT

   A. unplug the machine first.
   B. never open a power supply.
   C. put every screw in a labelled box.
   D. finish each machine on the day it arrives.

4. (Vocabulary in context) The word "dull" in the passage is closest in meaning to

   A. ordinary and not interesting.
   B. dark.
   C. difficult.
   D. dangerous.

5. (Reference) In the sentence, a long one in a short hole will go through something, the words "a long one" refer to

   A. a long box.
   B. a long screw.
   C. a long screwdriver.

D. a long wait.

6. (Inference) It can be inferred from the passage that the log is kept mainly because

A. the college requires a written record.
B. it proves how many machines they have mended.
C. patterns in it tell them what to check first next time.
D. they need it to claim on the warranty.

7. (Sentence insertion) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> Not every answer the bench gives is a repair.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

8. (Purpose of a paragraph) Why does the writer mention the capacitor?

A. To show how much Maysa knows about electronics.
B. To explain why one of the rules is absolute.
C. To warn the reader against buying cheap power supplies.
D. To describe how a laptop is built.

9. (Purpose of the whole passage) What is the writer's main purpose in the whole passage?

A. To teach the reader how to repair a laptop.
B. To describe how a small student repair bench works, and the judgement it takes to run one.
C. To argue that the college should pay for a workshop.
D. To compare two ways of cooling a computer.

10. (The writer's attitude) Which word best describes the writer's attitude towards Maysa and the bench?

A. Sentimental.
B. Admiring.
C. Critical.
D. Amused.

Part C — Fill in the blanks

Use these words. There are two extra words you will not need.

> capacitor · fault · warranty · component · log · dust · diagnose · static · bench

1. A _____ can hold a charge for days after the plug is pulled.

2. Touch the metal frame first, so the _____ on your hands goes somewhere harmless.
3. The fan was packed with _____.
4. Nine of the last twenty laptops had the same _____.
5. They keep a _____, and every machine gets a line in it.
6. A machine still under _____ should not be opened.
7. Put the screwdriver down before you touch a _____.

Part D — Summary

Write the story in two sentences only. Use must or must not once, and can or cannot once.

> Sentence 1 — what the rules at the bench are for: _____ Sentence 2 — what the bench can and cannot mend: _____